- In Candace's third year, she essentially tells Adam and Eve to finally treat the data as valuable not just for themselves but also as a product for others (in this case, Bob). Finally supplied with a proper *data product*, Bob is able to also optimize the costs of the business.

In summary, Candace focuses mostly on the principle of decentralized data ownership and data product thinking. Since her operation is small, she doesn't need to do much governance besides talking with her employees about using data in decision-making. She also does not have to use a large platform or any central platform besides maybe email, simply because there isn't yet a large mesh of data products to connect.

KEY POINT The value lies in decentralization, not in all four principles. We think that data meshes at the core are just about the decentralization of data ownership into any kind of *autonomous* unit. That can be an individual, a whole department, or anything, depending on the situation. The key principles are guidelines for helping us execute this decentralization process well.

We believe that the data mesh journey might begin at any size of an enterprise if you *feel the pull of decentralization*. We discuss that in more depth in chapter 2.

KEY POINT Data meshes are for companies of all sizes. The data mesh is a possible tool for companies of all sizes. But that does not mean it is the right tool for every company in its current stage. It can also be the wrong tool for a company (again, independent of its size). We discuss the decision process in chapter 2.

So why did Candace feel this *pull of decentralization*? And why will you feel it too at some point?

1.6 Socio-technical architecture

The data mesh is not a technical solution for data problems. The data mesh solves these problems by using a *socio-technical architecture*, or a socio-technical system design. We believe this is the biggest strength of the data mesh as a paradigm, and we think you should treat the socio-technical architecture as a foundation of your data mesh implementation. You need to apply socio-technical architecture consciously to make it successful.